CORVANE SYSTEMS

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Owner	Ethics & Compliance Office
Applies to	Employees, former employees, candidates, contractors, suppliers and their staff, shareholders and Board members

Speak-Up Policy

1. Why speaking up matters

Problems that are raised early are easier to fix. Corvane wants everyone to feel safe raising concerns about possible wrongdoing, without fear of retaliation. This policy explains what you can report, how to report it, what happens next and how you are protected. It follows the requirements of the EU Whistleblowing Directive.

2. What you can report

You can report any concern about actual or suspected misconduct connected to Corvane, for example:

- fraud, theft, bribery or corruption;
- breaches of the Code of Conduct or Corvane policies;
- breaches of laws, including data protection, competition and sanctions laws;
- harassment, discrimination or bullying;
- risks to health and safety or the environment;
- security vulnerabilities that are being ignored;
- attempts to hide any of the above.

Personal grievances that only concern your own employment, such as disagreement about a pay rise, are normally handled through the People Team grievance process instead. If you are not sure which route fits, use a speak-up channel and it will be routed correctly.

You do **not** need proof. You only need a **reasonable belief** that the information is true at the time you report it. You are protected even if the concern turns out to be mistaken, as long as you reported it honestly.

3. How to report

Channel	How	Anonymous?
Your manager or their manager	In person, by phone or in writing	No
People Team	people@corvane.example	No
Ethics & Compliance Office	compliance@corvane.example or in person	No (confidential)
Corvane Ethics Line	ethicsline.corvane.example or by phone, 24/7, in 20 languages; operated by an independent provider	Yes, if you choose

The **Corvane Ethics Line** is run by an independent company. When you report anonymously, you receive a **case number** and create a password. Use them to log back in, read follow-up questions from the investigators and receive feedback, without ever revealing your identity. Please check back regularly, because unanswered questions can make an anonymous concern harder to investigate.

You can also request a **face-to-face meeting** with the Ethics & Compliance Office, which will take place within a reasonable time.

Concerns about members of the Executive Team are routed directly to the Chair of the Audit Committee.

4. What happens after you report

1. **Acknowledgement**: you receive confirmation that your report was received within **7 days**.
2. **Assessment**: the Ethics & Compliance Office assesses the concern and decides whether an investigation is needed and who should investigate. Investigators are always independent of the people involved.
3. **Investigation**: investigators gather facts, interview people and review documents. They may ask you for more information.
4. **Feedback**: you receive feedback on the actions taken or planned within **3 months** of the acknowledgement. Corvane may not be able to share every detail, for example because of other people's privacy, but you will be told whether the matter was investigated and whether it was closed.
5. **Outcome**: where misconduct is confirmed, Corvane takes corrective action, which may include disciplinary measures, process changes or reporting to the authorities.

5. Confidentiality

The identity of the person who reports is shared only with the people who need it to handle the report, and only with the reporter's consent, unless the law requires disclosure. Trying to find out who made an anonymous report is prohibited and is a disciplinary offence.

6. Protection against retaliation

Corvane strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith, helps someone else report, or takes part in an investigation. Retaliation includes dismissal, demotion, withholding a

promotion or training, a negative performance review without basis, changes to duties or location, intimidation, exclusion and harm to reputation, including on social media.

If you believe you are experiencing retaliation, report it through any speak-up channel. Retaliation is investigated as a separate breach and can lead to dismissal.

Knowingly reporting false information is not protected and may lead to disciplinary action.

7. External reporting

We encourage you to report internally first, so we can act quickly. However, you always have the right to report directly to the competent national authority (for example the Dutch Whistleblowers Authority in the Netherlands) or to the relevant EU institution. Public disclosure, for example to the media, is protected in specific circumstances defined by law, such as when internal and external reports received no appropriate response, or when there is an imminent danger to the public interest.

8. Responsibilities

- **Everyone**: raise concerns early and cooperate with investigations.
- **Managers**: listen, take every concern seriously, pass it to the Ethics & Compliance Office within **2 working days**, and never investigate on their own or try to identify an anonymous reporter.
- **Ethics & Compliance Office**: run the process, protect reporters, and report statistics (without names) to the Audit Committee twice a year.

Fictional sample document created for the KnowGauge demo. Corvane Systems is not a real company, and this document is not legal or HR advice.